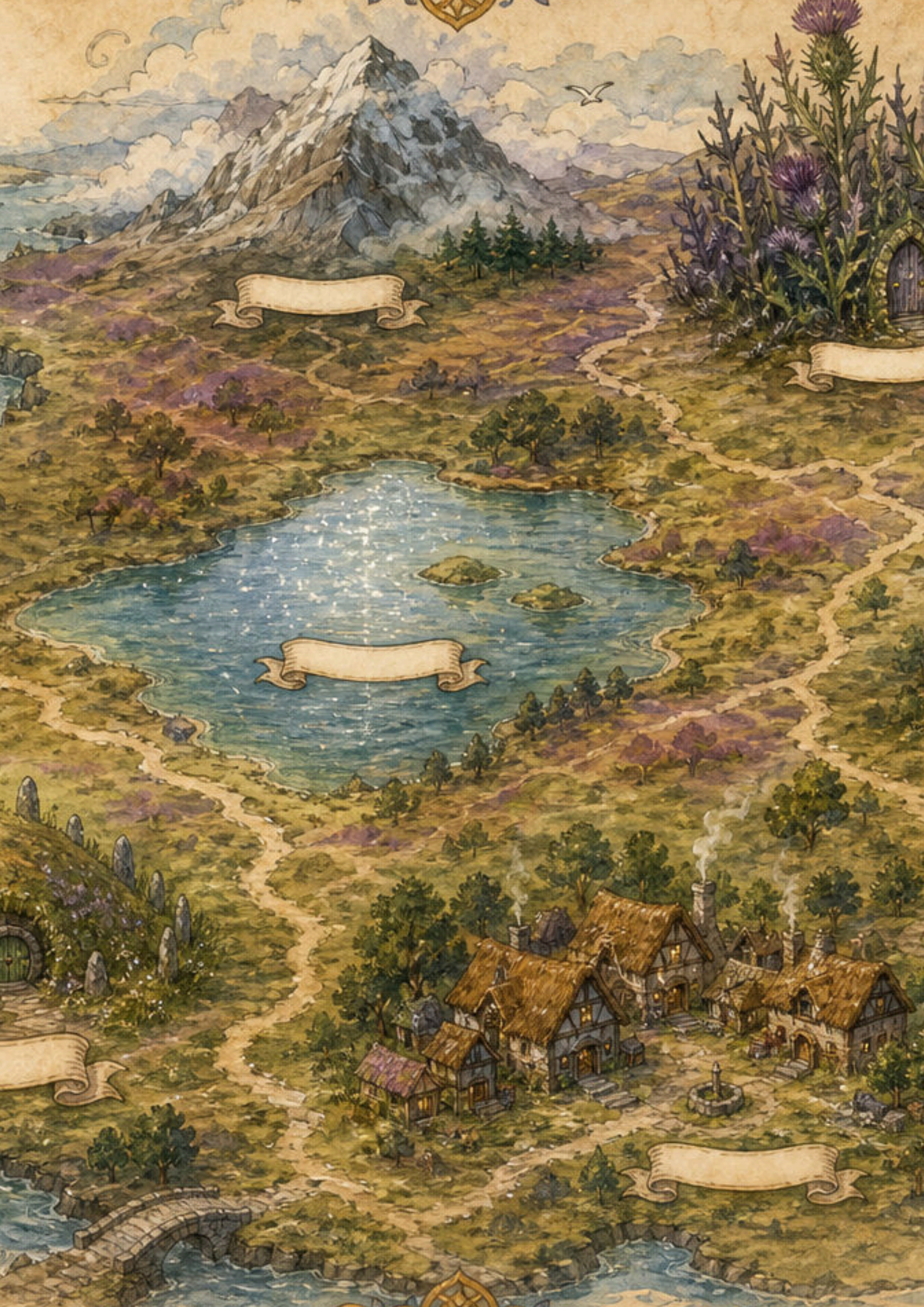
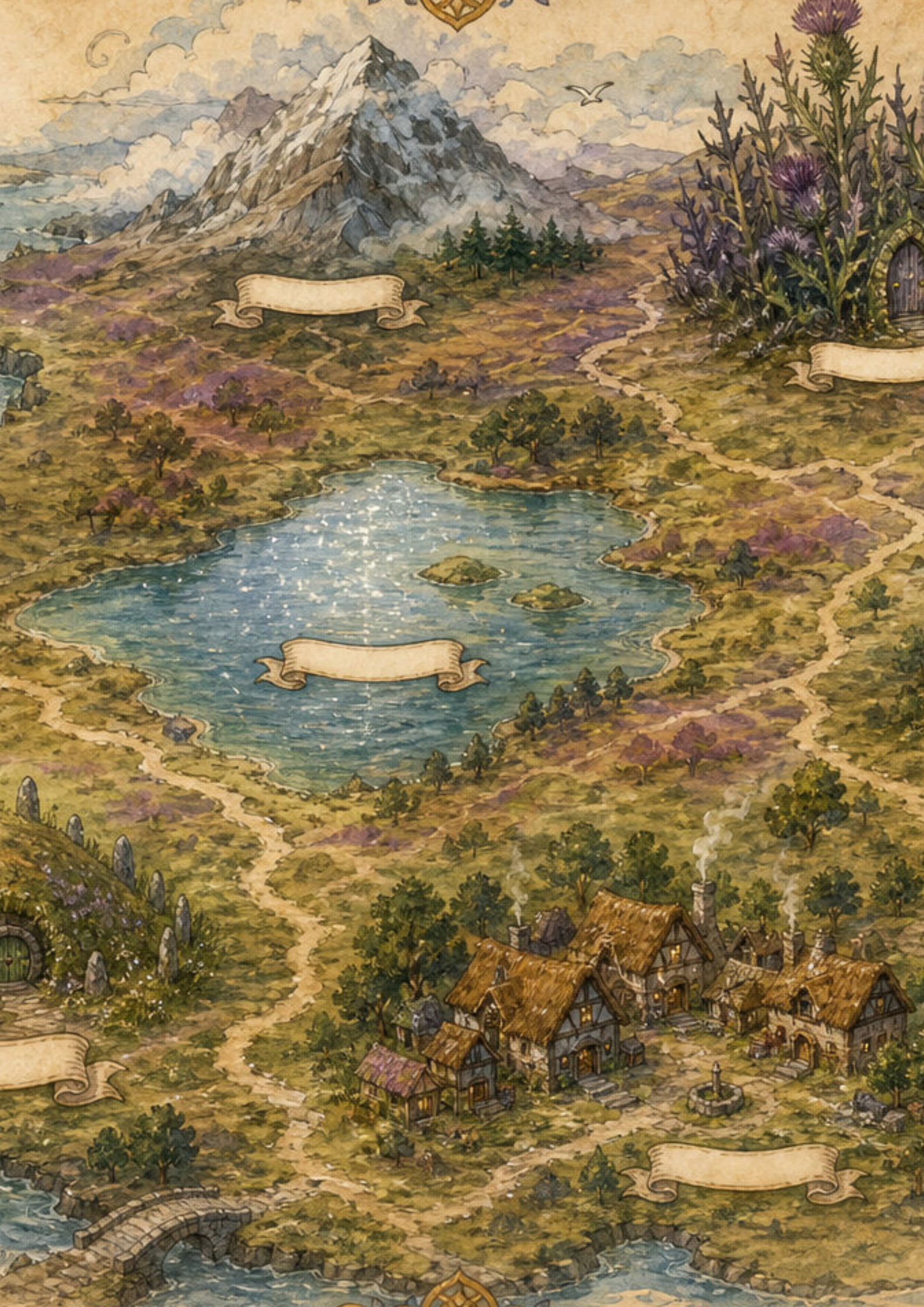






REGIONS OF ALBA

Region	Look	Adventure use
Heatherhigh Hills	Purple slopes, cairns, windy paths.	Giants, promises, weather magic.
Glass Loch	Still water, moon bridges, kelp bells.	Kelpies, serpents, reflection riddles.
Thistlewood	Brambles, hidden doors, fox tracks.	Sprites, lost paths, thorn bargains.
Crofters' Glen	Warm cottages, markets, oat fields.	Chores that become quests.
Hollow Hill	Fairy mound, ribbons, ghost wind.	Banshees, old names, warnings.

Town: Alba-Brae

A cozy market village with a crooked clocktower and a shop that sells useful string.

Town: Kettleford

Bridge town where goats demand manners and tinkers repair enchanted pots.

Wild site: Star Cairn

Old stones that hum when a promise is almost remembered.

Dungeon: Root Warrens

Friendly-dark tunnels under Thistlewood, full of bells, mice, and jam doors.

FACTIONS AND FAIRY COURTS

Friendly groups

- The Rowan Keepers remember promises.
- The Kettle Guild repairs tiny magical things.
- The Lantern Jellies guide lost swimmers.
- The Croft Circle trades gossip, oats, and maps.

Tricky courts

- The Thorn Court loves rules, flags, and compliments.
- The Moon Court speaks in dreams and reflections.
- The Soot Court hides useful things in messy places.
- The Cairn Court guards old names.

Faction question: who wants this problem solved, and who thinks the problem is useful?

HOLIDAYS, LEGENDS, AND GODS/SPIRITS

First Thistle Day

Adventurers tie ribbons to safe paths. Sprites demand tiny speeches.

Loch Lantern Night

Families float candle boats and ask the loch to remember kind names.

The Kindly Cailleach

An ancient winter spirit who tests manners, then gives warm socks.

The Rowan Stag

A spirit of honest paths. Its antlers glow when a promise is true.





ALBA LORE: HIGH FANTASY MEDIEVAL SCOTLAND

Alba is a northern kingdom of rain-dark castles, heather hills, lochs deep enough to remember the moon, fairy roads, clan halls, and mythral seams under ancient cairns.

The Crown of Alba

The king or queen rules by stone-oath: they must be accepted by clan, kirk, fairy court, and the Stone of Scone-Under-Stars.

Mythral

Mythral is moon-silver from old cairns. One mythral coin equals 100 gold; most folk never see one.

Fairy Law

Names, guest-right, promises, salt, iron, rowan, and music matter as much as swords.

The Border

Southern forts mark the road to the Dominion of Albion, whose nobles want maps, taxes, mythral, and obedience.

MAJOR FACTIONS OF ALBA

Factions should pull the party in different directions. Give every faction a useful ally, a dangerous hardliner, and a favor they can offer.

Faction	Style	Goal	Adventure hook
Clan MacThorn	Highland oath-warriors	Keep the old passes free.	A champion demands guest-right proof.
The Rowan Compact	Druids, seers, tree-wardens	Protect fairy roads and sacred groves.	A rowan grove accuses a town of oath-breaking.
The Kettle Guild	Tinkers, crafters, hearth-mages	Control enchantment recipes.	A stolen recipe makes cursed shields.
The Norse Sea-Kin	Vikings, traders, skalds, raiders	Trade, raid, and settle by oath.	A peaceful jarl needs help against draugr.
The Storm-Clans	So-called barbarians of the north	Defend clan law and old cauldrons.	They may ally with Alba if respected.
The Dominion of Albion	Southern imperial redcloaks	Tax, map, and conquer Alba.	Break an enchanted conquest banner.

ALBION, VIKINGS, AND BARBARIANS

The Dominion of Albion

Albion is a fantasy southern empire inspired by medieval border wars. The villains are imperial nobles, Redcloak officers, tax sorcerers, and conquest banners — not every person from the south.

- Redcloak patrols measure land with iron chains.
- Tax-mages try to rename hills so fairy law forgets them.
- Border captains fear Alba because Alba refuses to kneel.

Norse and storm-clan neighbors

Vikings can be raiders, traders, rivals, oath-keepers, or allies. The northern storm-clans are called barbarians by outsiders, but their own laws are strict: guest-right, fair challenge, clan debt, and truth-song.

- A Norse jarl may hire the party to end a draugr curse.
- A raider may become an ally after a feast-right promise.
- A storm-clan queen may fight Albion if her stolen cauldron is returned.



PLACES TO PUT ON MAPS

Place	Use	Secret
Dun Rowan	capital hill-fort and oath stone	the stone speaks in dreams.
Skerryvik	Norse harbor town	half the town wants peace, half wants raids.
Redwall March	southern border forts	an Albion banner is alive and lying.
Cauldron Pass	storm-clan mountain road	barbarian queen guards a mythral spring.
Saint Brigid's Well	healing and prophecy	poison cannot cross it at dawn.
The Black Bog	monster lair and ruined battlefield	a bog drake sleeps on lost redcloak gold.